

17. Little Pond

Shoreline length: 12 km



Shore Types

Little Pond SMU includes an open coastline facing East and an estuary protected by a barrier sandspit, with a majority of wetlands, cliffs, and low plains.

% Shore types within SMU

low plain	bluff	sloped armour	cliff	wetland	vertical struct.	dunes	sandspit
24	4	0	27	33	0	0	12

Governance, Infrastructure, and Economy

The Little Pond shore falls entirely within the Rural Municipality of Annandale-Little Pond-Howe Bay.

Coastal infrastructure includes Shore Lane (Little Pond, at the beach), Ark Lane also falls inside the hazard area. There are no major coastal economic drivers identified. Local and legacy land use constraints include few 20 small lots on private roads along the coast.

Natural Assets and Heritage

The area includes the McKenzie Homestead, a historical landmark on Spry Point Road, and Sally's Beach Provincial Day Park to the south of the sandspit.

The shoreline includes critical habitat for bird species including the endangered Piping Plover and threatened Bank Swallow.



Outer shore including sandspit, Sally's Beach Provincial Day Park and Cape Spry



Sally's Beach Provincial Day Park



Eroding cliffs at Cape Spry supplying sand to downdrift beaches including Sally's Beach

Planning and Policy Framework

The municipality does not have planning and provincial rules apply. Land use and development is managed under provincial development standards, which include horizontal coastal building setbacks based on edge of feature and a calculation of erosion over time, building setbacks for dunes, and a requirement for a coastal buffer for new subdivisions.

There are no specific flood elevations identified in regulations, but coastal hazard assessments are typically conducted.

Sediment transport

Sediment transport is highest along the exposed seaside, notably cliffs which feed Sally's Beach and the barrier spit. It is lower inside the estuary.

Coastal Flood and Erosion Risk

While low plains and wetland shores are vulnerable to increasing flood hazards, infrastructure risk is low. The erosion hazard is highest along the exposed east shoreline. Erosion hazard inside the estuary is limited by the sheltered exposure and barrier sandspit.

The following flood risk indicator is based on the even with 1% annual exceedance probability (100-year return) with increasing amounts of sea level rise (SLR). The erosion risk indicator is based on potential future shoreline change for areas with historical data, not including salt marshes.

Estimated number of buildings and length of road at risk [per km shoreline]

	FLOOD RISK				EROSION RISK		
	Present	Short-term 0.3m SLR (2050)	Medium-term 0.6m SLR (2080)	Long-term 1.2m SLR (2130)	Short-term (~2050)	Medium-term (~2080)	Long-term (~2130)
Buildings	0	0	0	0	0	1 [<1/km]	4 [<1/km]
Roads	4 m [<1 m/km]	5 m [<1 m/km]	5 m [<1 m/km]	7 m [1 m/km]	4 m [<1 m/km]	8 m [1 m/km]	16 m [1 m/km]

Proposed SMP Strategies

	Short-term	Medium-term	Long-term
Sea level rise range	0 – 0.3 m	0.3 – 0.6 m	0.6 – 1.2 m
Potential timeframe	2030 - 2050	2050 - 2080	2080 - 2130
SMU 17.00 Little Pond	NAI	MR	MR
Rationale	It is critical to maintain sediment transport towards the sandspit protecting the bay. Given the low risk levels the proposed strategy is initially No Active Intervention. Managed Realignment will then reduce risk to the limited number of vulnerable assets and the need for future intervention.		

The table above shows how the recommended shoreline management unit (SMU) or policy unit (PU) strategy evolves across three planning epochs (Short-, Medium-, and Long-term) under increasing sea-level rise and erosion projections.

Adaptation strategies are preliminary recommendations subject to further development with feedback from community and government. These strategies are not approvals, commitments or policy determinations.